

n Harbour

Therapy for children, young people, parents and families · Stroud

PREPARED BY
Alexander Watson Studio

STAGE
Before website design

STATUS
For your review

DATE
September 2026

The direction of the website is decided here.

A Practice Clarity Blueprint sets the strategic and creative direction for Harbour before any design work begins: how the organisation is described, who each part of the website speaks to, how it should sound, and how it should look. Once it is agreed, the design stage builds on these decisions instead of reopening them.

Read it as a description of Harbour that you are entitled to correct. Where something is factually wrong, correct it. Where the wording is right but not yours, say so as well. One person should hold the pen: five sets of comments arriving separately make a slower build and a less coherent site.

UNDERSTANDING THE ORGANISATION

- 01 Practice at a glance
- 02 Organisational identity
- 03 Philosophy of practice
- 04 The people you want to reach
- 05 Messaging and voice
- 06 Intended experience

CREATIVE RECOMMENDATION

- 07 Brand direction
- 08 Logo and identity
- 09 Colour
- 10 Typography
- 11 Imagery
- 12 Website translation

SUMMARY AND APPROVAL

- 13 Practice Clarity Snapshot
- 14 Approval and next step

TO CONFIRM BEFORE PUBLICATION

Professional register and membership number for each practitioner · Safeguarding lead, policy and DBS status · Insurance · Supervision · ICO registration, notes policy and retention · Complaints procedure · Out-of-hours and crisis signposting · Measured access dimensions · Current waiting time · Reduced-rate places

These are deliberately blank. Nothing of this kind will appear on the website until you supply it.

HOW TO READ IT

- **Established.** Facts you have given us. Nothing factual has been assumed; anything not yet established is listed below instead of being filled in.
- **Interpretation.** Our reading of what those facts imply. Much of this document is interpretation, and correcting it is the main purpose of your review.
- **Recommendation.** Proposals for the identity and the website. Approve, adjust or refuse them.

Each page is marked at the top right: the first six sections set out our understanding of the organisation, the next six turn it into creative recommendations.

A NOTE ON CLINICAL LANGUAGE

Where this document describes how children, privacy, endings or families work, it is reporting Harbour's position, not stating a general truth about therapy. If any sentence claims more than you would claim to a parent, mark it. That is the most useful correction you can make.

Five people, one building, four ways in.

THE ORGANISATION

A five-person therapy centre in a converted chapel in Stroud. Four therapists and Mel, who answers the phone. Three rooms. Children, young people, parents and whole families are seen under one roof rather than referred between services.

THE PEOPLE

Four readerships with genuinely different fears, not one client. Many arrive unsure the difficulty is serious enough to justify the call, and many have waited a long time somewhere else first.

THE CENTRAL CONCERN

Arrival rather than treatment. What the team describes as stopping a family is mostly unknown and mostly not clinical: the door, the cost, the confidentiality rule, and whether they are allowed to be here at all.

THE FEELING TO CREATE

Oriented, unhurried and not yet committed. Taken seriously without having to prove severity, and able to stop at any point without having to explain why.

Most of the fear in a first appointment is about the building, not the therapy. Where do I park. Which door. Who will be looking at me. Where do I wait. Is there a toilet.

THE HARBOUR TEAM, AT DISCOVERY

OUR READING

This is the sentence the organisation appears to be built around. Harbour treats the practical conditions of coming — the hour, the room, the rules, the price — as part of the care rather than as the administration surrounding it. Section 03 sets that reading out in full, and everything after it follows from whether you agree.

THE PRACTICAL FACTS

Session fee	£65
Session length	50 minutes
First conversation	Free, twenty minutes, with a therapist
Family sessions	Fortnightly
Review points	Session six, then roughly every eight
Typical wait	Two to four weeks
Referral	Not required
Rooms	Three, up thirteen stairs; no lift

Specific, and small enough for that to be true.

Small, on purpose

Five people, and small enough that nobody is handed between them. Scale is described as a working condition rather than apologised for as a limitation, and it is checkable: the whole organisation fits in one sentence.

Experienced, and unstartled

The emotional offer is composure rather than sympathy — someone who has met this before and is not alarmed by it. Our reading is that this answers a worry parents do not often state: that describing the problem will make it worse.

Specific rather than soothing

A kettle that works. Thirteen stairs with a handrail on one side only. Doorways of 810mm. Precision does the reassuring, and it can be checked on arrival.

Willing to be limited

A published list of what Harbour will not do: no diagnoses, no medication, no court reports, no crisis cover, no taking sides. Roughly one call in six ends with a referral somewhere else.

Unhurried, and unprogrammed

Some people come for six weeks and some for a year; nobody is put on a programme. Family sessions are fortnightly because, in Harbour's account, families need the gap.

Candid about its own faults

The access information is written honestly, including what does not work, and the first line under that heading is that there is no lift. Nothing about the building is presented as better than it is.

A five-person therapy centre in one building, which tells children, teenagers, parents and families what will happen before it happens — and is small enough for that to be true.

IDENTITY STATEMENT

The second clause is the load-bearing one. The promise is ordinary; being small enough to keep it is what makes the promise checkable.

WORDS THE WEBSITE WILL NOT USE ABOUT ITSELF

Safe · caring · compassionate · nurturing · inclusive · expert

Each of these is either demonstrated by a published fact or left unsaid. An adjective cannot be checked before arriving, and most practices in the category already use all six.

► RECOMMENDATION

What holds the hour is part of the work.

Our reading of the position you described. It decides what the website is organised around, so it is worth disagreeing with if we have it wrong.

Across four kinds of work, one argument keeps returning in different words: the structure around a session is not administration wrapped around the useful part. The same hour, the same room, a beginning and an end that are held, a privacy rule everyone knows in advance — these are described as the conditions that make the work possible, not the courtesies surrounding it.

Three positions appear to organise everything else, all stated as Harbour’s own rather than as findings about therapy: that predictability is part of the care; that privacy is what makes honesty affordable in this room; and that most of the change happens outside the building — which is why parent work is a route in its own right, and family sessions are fortnightly.

A fourth follows: if the work is a set of conditions rather than a treatment, it has to stay examinable. Hence the review at session six, the reviews after it, and the willingness to say that this is not helping.

Vagueness makes children more anxious, not less.

HARBOUR'S POSITION, AT DISCOVERY

WHAT FOLLOWS FROM IT

- The website's job is to establish the conditions, not to describe a method. Sequence, room, price, rule and ending are the content.
- Rules are published with the reason attached, so a reader meets the reason at the same moment as the rule.
- Stopping is a designed option rather than a failure, and review points and endings are described from outside so that entering commits less.
- Difficulty is described rather than classified. There is no diagnosis here, so the site cannot ask a reader to supply one.
- Because change is located largely at home, there is no incentive to maximise sessions — part of why publishing the fee here is ordinary rather than brave.

□ HOW FAR THIS CLAIM GOES

This is Harbour's account of why it works the way it does, and the site will present it that way — as what this centre has found, with these families. It will not be written as a general statement about children, about anxiety, or about what therapy does. If you would put it more cautiously, or not in public at all, say so.

Four readerships, not one client.

This sets who each part of the website speaks to most directly. It is a question of emphasis in the writing, not a limit on who you will see or a clinical boundary.

Children

ROUGHLY 4–11

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Mornings a battle. Sleep gone. Stomach aches with nothing medical behind them. Rage, then remorse. Or a child who has become very, very good.

WHAT THEY FEAR

Being taken somewhere to be discussed, and being made to say why.

WHAT THEY NEED TO KNOW

What the room looks like, whether the grown-up stays, and whether they have to talk.

WHAT CONTROL THEY NEED

Not talking. Saying they want to stop and go home.

HOW TO WRITE TO THEM

Directly, in short sentences, in an ordinary voice – not a cheerful one.

Young people

12–18

WHAT IS HAPPENING

School has stopped being tolerable. Friendships have gone strange. Someone at home is not okay. Feeling nothing. Self-harm.

WHAT THEY FEAR

That it gets reported home. Being assessed. Being spoken to in the careful voice.

WHAT THEY NEED TO KNOW

Exactly where the confidentiality line sits. A map of it, not a reassurance about it.

WHAT CONTROL THEY NEED

Making contact without a parent. Declining to answer. Stopping, with notice and a say in how.

HOW TO WRITE TO THEM

Second person, adult register, nothing designed to talk them into anything

Parents and carers

OFTEN THE FIRST TO MAKE CONTACT

WHAT IS HAPPENING

A change that has lasted past six weeks. Strategies that used to work have stopped. The household organised around one child.

WHAT THEY FEAR

Being found to be the cause. Wasting a professional's time. Being shut out of what their child says. The cost.

WHAT THEY NEED TO KNOW

Fees, timescales, whether a referral is needed, and precisely what they will and will not be told.

WHAT CONTROL THEY NEED

Parent work as a route in its own right. Where to wait. Asking someone else to make the first contact.

HOW TO WRITE TO THEM

Adult to adult. No verdict on their parenting, and no suggestion they should have come sooner.

Families

ATTENDING TOGETHER

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The same argument on a loop. A separation. A step-family that has not settled. A bereavement everyone is handling privately.

WHAT THEY FEAR

Being put on trial. One person carrying the blame. Children questioned in front of adults.

WHAT THEY NEED TO KNOW

What a session physically looks like, who speaks first, who needs to attend, and whether family work is the right route at all.

WHAT CONTROL THEY NEED

Starting with one person and seeing. Stopping a session that tips towards prosecution.

HOW TO WRITE TO THEM

Plural and even-handed. No member of the family is the subject of the page.

WHY THE ROUTES STAY SEPARATE

The sentence a fourteen-year-old most needs stated — that what they say is not relayed home — is the one their parent is most anxious about. Written once, for both, it serves neither. It has to be written twice, differently, and each reader has to be able to find their own version without reading the other one first.

One question underneath all four.

None of the four is certain they qualify. The parent is not sure the problem is serious enough; the teenager is not sure they count as having a reason; the family is not sure this is what family therapy is for. Underneath all of them sits the same question: *do we qualify for this, and what exactly happens if I ask?*

Our reading is that the barrier is not stigma and not scepticism about therapy, but a threshold: an idea, often picked up from previous services, that help is limited and has to be justified by being bad enough. This is an assumption we are asking you to approve, not a finding.

Earlier is easier, and ‘I think I might be overreacting’ is one of the most common opening lines we hear.

AT DISCOVERY

Naming that doubt in the reader’s own words, and calling it ordinary, turns it from a disqualification into a sign that they are in the usual place. We would put it above the four routes rather than below them.

RECOGNITION RATHER THAN CLASSIFICATION

- A category is a gate you can fail. A parent who cannot decide between anxiety and behaviour may conclude the service is not for them.
- A category requires a claim about your child. “Mornings have become a battle” commits a parent to nothing. Naming a disorder commits them to a great deal.
- Few arrive with the vocabulary. Harbour’s account is that people describe a scene rather than present a condition. The site should be written in the language of the call.
- Several scenes give several chances. A list of recognisable situations offers repeated opportunities to think *that is us*. A taxonomy offers one opportunity to be sorted.

□ OUR READING, FROM THE WAY ENQUIRIES ARRIVE

HOW EACH ONE DECIDES

Children	Do not decide. An adult decides for them, and then has to explain it to them.
Young people	Decide alone, usually on a phone, often at night, sometimes from a link they did not ask for.
Parents and carers	Weigh cost, disclosure and the fear of being blamed — the questions the team says it hears first.
Families	Decide collectively, and often disagree. The page has to survive being read by someone who does not want to come.

One message, said to four people at once.

We will tell you what happens before it happens.

PRIMARY MESSAGE

SUPPORTING

You can look at all of it first – the room, the price, the rule about what gets told – before you commit to anything.

SUPPORTING

Nobody here needs you to be certain, articulate, or in crisis. You do not have to know what to call it.

SUPPORTING

You will know what is private and what is not, and you will know it before you say anything.

SUPPORTING

If Harbour is not the right place, it will say so, and it will say where to go instead.

HOW IT SHOULD SOUND

Plain, exact and composed. Short declaratives; real numbers; the awkward thing named first rather than buried. Occasionally dry — a Rubik's cube nobody has solved, books none of which are about feelings — but never cheerful by default and never brave on the reader's behalf.

Warmth arrives through accuracy rather than adjective: the kettle works, the stairs are counted, the ending is counted down. That is a rule about writing, not a ban on kindness — where something needs saying gently, it is said gently and briefly, then followed by a fact.

The voice sits closest to a competent professional writing a careful letter: unhurried, exact, assuming intelligence. It has to work for a fourteen-year-old and a forty-year-old on the same site, which is why plainness does the job that simplification would otherwise be asked to do.

EMBRACE

- Concrete nouns — the sand tray, the kettle, ear defenders, thirteen stairs
- Actual numbers — £65, 50 minutes, six sessions, 810mm
- Named people, in the sentence where they matter
- Rules with the reason attached
- Plainly stated limits and refusals
- Real sequences, in the order they happen
- Explicit options, including stopping

AVOID

- Journey, holistic, bespoke pathway, passionate about
- Safe space, offered as a claim rather than a described condition
- Any promise about how a child will be afterwards
- Modality names in navigation — systemic, psychodynamic, integrative
- Language that reads as written for children rather than to them
- Asking anyone to be brave before they have been told anything
- Exclamation marks, and forced positivity of any kind

THE TEST FOR ANY SENTENCE ON THE SITE

Would this read the same way to a fourteen-year-old finding it alone as to their parent reading it a week later? If not, it belongs on one of the two pages and not on both — and neither version is the softened one.

Oriented, unhurried, and not yet committed.

FEEL	UNDERSTAND	TRUST	DO
Recognition without exposure: nothing is being sold, and nothing is being decided about them while they read. The page should read as though an adult wrote it and is not performing.	Within a minute: what Harbour is, which of four routes might fit, what happens next, what it costs, what stays private, and what the building is like.	Built out of disclosed specifics — the fee, the stairs, the confidentiality line, the referrals elsewhere — rather than out of claims about care.	Start a conversation: twenty minutes, free, with a therapist, nothing required in advance. It ends in a decision, and the decision can be that Harbour is not the right place.

WHAT THAT CHANGES ABOUT EACH PAGE

Children	Young people	Parents and carers	Families
Written to be spoken aloud. Its job is to make the room describable by an adult who has not seen it either.	The confidentiality line and an independent way to make contact come before anything else on the page.	Nothing they need sits behind an enquiry: fees, timescales and what they will be told are on the page.	The physical shape of a session — the room, the chairs, who speaks first — before anyone agrees to sit in it.

CONTROL, HANDED BACK — THE CHOICES THE SITE SHOULD MAKE VISIBLE

— Look round the building first, with no appointment and nothing asked	— Ask for a different therapist, without giving a reason	— Stop, with notice and a say in how the ending is done
— Decline to answer anything, in the call or in the room	— Have someone else make the first contact on your behalf	— Be told plainly that somewhere else would suit you better

Removing unknowns is only half of it. The site should also make the system legible enough that a reader can make an informed choice inside it — a different job from reassurance.

STATED IN YOUR OWN VOICE, AS CONTENT RATHER THAN SMALL PRINT

There is no lift, and thirteen stairs · Not a crisis service, with plain out-of-hours signposting · Roughly one call in six ends with a referral somewhere else · Late cancellation is charged, and the reason it is charged · What Harbour will not do · Who reads an enquiry before a therapist does

Eight stages, and what each one has to settle.

STAGE	WHAT IS UNCERTAIN	WHAT HARBOUR TELLS THEM	WHAT SHOULD BE TRUE AFTERWARDS
Looking for help	Is this even a problem? Am I overreacting?	Recognisable situations rather than conditions, with the permission clause directly beneath them.	Recognised, and not presumptuous for being here.
Choosing a route	Which of these am I? What if I pick wrong?	Four routes, described plainly, with the fact that none of them is a locked door and the first call will re-route anyone.	Oriented, without having committed.
Making contact	Who reads this? What will they ask me?	Mel takes basic details, is not a therapist, and will not ask clinical questions. Reply within one working day.	Safe to send three words rather than a history.
The free call	Is this a sales call? Am I being assessed?	Twenty minutes with a therapist. No full history, no assessment, and one of four honest outcomes — one of which is a referral elsewhere.	That a decision is being made <i>with</i> them, and can go either way.
First visit	Which door? Where do I wait? What if my child will not get out of the car?	The sequence from parking to leaving, in order — no bell, no intercom, first names only out loud.	Able to picture it, and to describe it to a child.
Sessions	What actually happens in there? Do I have to talk?	Described separately by age, with what is allowed stated as a list that begins with not talking	That the hour has a shape, and nobody is required to perform in it.
Reviews	How would I know if this is working? Am I allowed to say it is not?	Asked out loud at session six, then roughly every eight. A rough patch around sessions four to seven is named in advance.	That doubt is expected and scheduled, rather than a failure.
Ending	Will this just stop?	Three or four sessions of notice, marked each week. Something made to take home. Coming back later is common and is not a relapse.	That the ending was designed rather than administered.

WHY THIS IS NOT AN FAQ

An FAQ answers questions a visitor has already formed. This sequence answers the ones people have not dared to ask — and it is used twice: once by the person deciding, and again as a script for describing the visit to a child.

WHAT THAT MEANS FOR THE BUILD

The eight stages are the spine of the site, not a page within it. Each one appears where a reader would need it rather than collected in one place, and each carries its price where it has one.

You should be able to understand the place before you enter it.

The identity should look like a well-made public building rather than a clinic or a children's service: quiet, orderly, generously spaced, and organised so the useful information is the easiest thing to find. Its job is to let a reader work out where they are without having to ask anyone.

One principle explains the whole system: everything is legible before it is welcoming – clarity is how the welcome is delivered, not a delay before it arrives. That decides the typography – practical information in the more readable face, never the smaller one. It decides the colour – four routes marked by position rather than meaning, never by colour alone. It decides the imagery – drawings that can be measured rather than pictures that can only be liked. And it decides the writing, which states the awkward thing before the comforting one.

The four audiences are held at equal weight throughout. Nothing is styled as the children's part of the site, because a fourteen-year-old reading a page designed for a seven-year-old would reasonably conclude it was not written for them.

Legible before it is welcoming.

DESIGN PRINCIPLE

WHAT IT CARRIES

- One repeated architectural form, used sparingly
- Practical information in the strongest position on every page
- Four audiences equal in weight, colour and tone
- Structure without institution – order, but no signage
- Warmth as a by-product of accuracy
- Enough space to be read slowly, on a bad night

WHAT IT AVOIDS

- Children's-brand shapes, mascots and primary colour
- Hospital and clinic cues – badges, blues, signage systems
- Wellness palettes, gradients and soft-focus calm
- Charity campaign photography and its moral register
- Premium private-clinic styling, which makes cost a status question
- Decorative reassurance and performative friendliness

One arch, drawn once.

The building has arched openings, so the form describes Harbour before it symbolises anything. That is the reason to keep it: it is a drawing of the place, not a metaphor for the service.

It is open at the base, which keeps it an opening rather than a container, and stops it reading as a shield or a badge. And it survives being small: at 16px it is still an arch, which a more literal building would not be.

We have deliberately not extended the symbolism. It is not also a harbour, a bridge, a rainbow or an entrance to a journey. One idea, held all the way through.

▣ WHERE IT WAS TESTED

At 16px as a favicon · reversed on green · at the head of a fourteen-year-old's page, where it must not become playful · above a fee table, where it must not become decorative · and printed in one colour on a letter.

AT WORKING SIZE



The opening is what has to survive: below 32px the stroke thickens and the aperture widens so the arch does not close up.

PRIMARY LOCKUP



Cover, correspondence, print. The mark sits at cap height beside the name and shares its stroke weight, so the two read as one object.

MARK ALONE · SMALL USE



Favicon, app icon, and the marker beside a route label. The small-use variant thickens the stroke and widens the aperture so the opening survives.

CONSTRUCTION

- Aperture width = 0.75 × overall height, on the centreline
- The jamb is five-eighths of the height; the curve is the other three
- Stroke = the stem weight of the wordmark at the same size

HORIZONTAL LOCKUP



Website header and footer. The descriptor is set in the sans, letterspaced, and never in the serif.

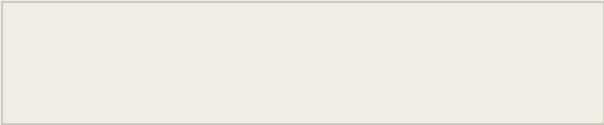
ON HARBOUR GREEN · REVERSED



Footer, closing bands and print covers. One colour only in both directions; there is no second-colour version of the mark.

- Clear space = one aperture width on all four sides
- Minimum width 22mm, or 88px; below that, the small-use variant
- Never filled, closed at the base, outlined, rotated, patterned or on an image

Three colours that do the work. Four that only say where you are.



Limestone

#EFEDE5

THE PAGE

A warm neutral ground, slightly grey rather than cream. The default surface for everything read.



Harbour green

#22453A

THE ORGANISATION'S OWN VOICE

All primary type, the mark, every action, and the full-bleed bands where Harbour speaks as itself. 9.0:1 on limestone.



Stone

#5F6763

LABELS

Anything that names something rather than saying it: labels, table headings, captions, form hints. 5.0:1.



Silt

#CFCBBE

HAIRLINE

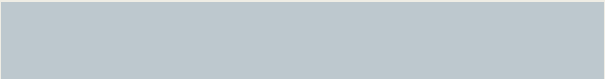
One weight only, as the rules that separate information. Never a fill, never type, never a border round a box.

THE FOUR ROUTE COLOURS — POSITIONAL, NOT SYMBOLIC



Clay #D9C6B2

CHILDREN



Slate #BDC8CE

YOUNG PEOPLE



Moss #C4CCB4

PARENTS AND CARERS



Heather #CCC0CD

FAMILIES

They say which of four parallel routes you are on, and let a returning reader recognise they are back where they were. They mean nothing else: the assignment is arbitrary and could be permuted without loss. None is the childish one.

Held at one weight, the four are also close in grayscale and under common colour-vision differences — which is why the name and the fixed position do the identifying, and the colour only confirms it.

THE RULES

- Named, positioned, then coloured — in that priority. Colour is never the only signal.
- Two places only: a page-head band, and a marker beside a route label.
- Never behind body text, never on a button, never as type.
- All four within four points of one another in lightness, so none reads louder.
- No fifth colour, no gradient, no shadow, no second accent.

PROPORTION ON ANY SCREEN



Limestone 78 Harbour green 15 Stone 3.5 Silt 1.6 Route colours 2 combined.

A serif for the place.
A sans for the facts.

NEWSREADER · PRODUCTION TYPE

Aa Harbour

Headings, the organisation's own sentences, and anything quoted. An old-chapel register without institutional coldness — a text serif made for reading rather than for display, which is why it holds up in a long paragraph at text size.

HIERARCHY

DISPLAY	Newsreader Light, 44/1.14	Room to arrive.
BODY	Newsreader Regular, 17/1.65	Nothing here is rushed.
QUOTED SPEECH	Newsreader Light Italic, 21	<i>You do not have to talk.</i>
LABEL	Inter Medium, 11, letterspaced	WHAT IT COSTS
PRACTICAL DATA	Inter Regular, 16, tabular	£65 · 50 minutes

INTER · RASMUS ANDERSSON

£65 50 min 810mm

Every fee, time, measurement, step, label, table, form and navigation item. A neutral grotesque with open apertures and tabular figures, chosen because it stays unambiguous at small sizes and in dense tables. Regular 400, Medium 500 and Semibold 600 only.

THE RULE

Anything a reader has to act on — a price, a time, a measurement, a step, an address — is set in Inter, because it stays clearest at small sizes and in dense tables. Anything Harbour says about itself is set in Newsreader. The practical material is never the smaller of the two, and never the lighter.

SET FOR THE READER WHO HAS THE LEAST LEFT

- Body text 17px minimum, at 1.65; measure held between 62 and 72 characters
- The Reading control offers 17 / 19 / 21px and 1.65 / 1.9 line height, remembered on the device
- Tabular figures in every fee, time and measurement, so columns align without rules
- No type below 13px anywhere, including captions, footnotes and legal text
- No justified text, no letterspaced serif, no all-capital serif, no italic for emphasis
- No third typeface, and no more than two heading sizes on a page

Drawn where accuracy matters. Photographed where recognition does.

No image on this site contains a person. A practice that publishes a safeguarding policy cannot photograph its clients, so any photograph of a child would be a model – a staged image on a site that otherwise stages nothing. A photographed child is also always a particular age, gender and ethnicity, and Harbour serves four to eighteen plus adults; whoever is in the picture, most readers are not. Distressed children perform the distress the site is trying to lower, and smiling families make the outcome promise Harbour refuses to make.

That leaves a real question, which we have answered by splitting the job rather than choosing one medium. **Outside, recognition matters.** Someone arriving is matching what they see against what they were shown, and a photograph does that more directly than a drawing can. **Inside, information matters.** A drawing can be measured, labelled and simplified – where the seating is, where the toilet is, how wide the door is – and it does not present a therapy room as an interior to be admired.

THE RULE

Imagery carries information before it carries atmosphere. In calm mode, the drawings and the photographs both stay, because both are content; what goes is the decorative texture around them.

NOT MADE AT ALL

Any image of a client · models posed as a family · a distressed child · a smiling family · mugs, pebbles, sunlight through leaves · anything staged to resemble a session · illustrated children as decoration

A DECISION FOR YOU

Whether you are willing to have the building and entrance photographed at all. Photographs may make the entrance easier to recognise on the day; drawings can carry the same information less directly. Either way the system holds.

PHOTOGRAPHED — THE APPROACH ONLY

- The building from the pavement, at the distance and angle a person first sees it
- The entrance door, straight on, in daylight, with the number legible
- The parking area with the entrance in frame, so the walk is obvious
- The foot of the stairs, showing the handrail and which side it is on

Daylight, no styling, no people, no wide angle. Square corners, no filter, no grade towards warmth. Four is the upper limit, and the site should work if the fourth is never taken.

DRAWN — EVERYTHING INDOORS

- Each of the three rooms, in plan and in one elevation, empty and to scale
- The route from the car park to the waiting area, as a simple plan
- Where the toilet is, in relation to the waiting area
- The layout of a family session – the chairs, and who sits where

One line weight, one flat tint from the route colour of the page, no shading, no texture, no perspective tricks. Labelled in the sans, at body-text size.

What follows for the website.

Each requirement follows from a conclusion on an earlier page. The left column mixes what you have told us with our reading of it; where it is our reading, the wording says so. If a conclusion changes when you review it, the requirement beside it changes with it.

STRATEGIC CONCLUSION	DESIGN REQUIREMENT
Four readerships with different fears cannot be served by one page.	Routing happens before any service description is attempted. Four named routes in the first screen, in a fixed order, each with its own page, its own position, its own colour marker and its own enquiry destination. No combined services page anywhere on the site.
A young person sent a link by an adult has to be able to read it as their own.	Their page opens by naming that exact situation, is written in the second person throughout, states the confidentiality line in the first screen, and carries an enquiry that reaches a named therapist rather than a shared inbox or a parent.
Arrival, not treatment, is where the team describes people stopping — the door, the wait, the toilet. We have taken that as the site’s organising assumption.	Building information is a primary section with the same weight as a service page — approach, door, waiting, toilets, sound, light, temperature, stairs and what does not work — with a standing invitation to look round first, with no appointment.
Sequence and cost are the two unknowns that stop people, and separately each is incomplete.	The eight-stage process occupies major homepage space with the price against each stage and the first stage free, answering <i>what would it cost me simply to find out</i> at a glance. Fees are never behind an enquiry.
Few arrive with the vocabulary, and a category is a gate a reader can fail.	Recognisable situations in place of a condition or service list, in the language people actually use on the phone, with the permission clause set immediately beneath them rather than further down the page.
A rule stated without its reason reads as a condition imposed rather than information given.	Confidentiality, cancellation, reviews and endings are each stated with their reason, in the body of the site, in the place a reader meets them — not collected into a policies page and not set in small print.
Being handed between practitioners is what the organisation is small in order to avoid.	The whole staff named in a single line, including the person who answers the phone and the fact that she is not a therapist, rather than a grid of credentials.
Harbour describes much of its readership as reading late, on a phone, or too tired to concentrate.	A Reading control in the header of every page — text size, line spacing and calm mode, remembered on the device — treated as ordinary infrastructure rather than a compliance feature. Specified on page 17.
Asking should cost nothing and commit to nothing, since roughly one call in six ends somewhere else.	One action, worded <i>Start a conversation</i> , repeated in the same form everywhere and never phrased as booking. The contact page states that asking is not the same as agreeing to anything.

The parts a designer can build from.

HOMEPAGE, IN ORDER

- What Harbour is, in one sentence, with the fee, the free call and the wait beside it
- The four routes
- Recognisable situations, with the permission clause
- The process, with prices
- The building
- The people, in one line, including who answers the phone
- Start a conversation

INFORMATION HIERARCHY

On every page, practical before emotional. Nothing that costs money, restricts access or governs disclosure sits more than one screen from the top of the page it belongs to. Emotional writing earns its place after the facts are settled, never instead of them.

CALLS TO ACTION

Use: Start a conversation · Ask · Look round first · Email Sam directly.
Never: Book now · Begin your journey · Get started · Take the first step.

PRACTICAL INFORMATION

Fees, access, confidentiality, cancellation, what Harbour will not do and crisis signposting are content with their own place in the page order. There is no FAQ page; nothing important is filed behind a question.

MOBILE

The young person's page and the building page are designed at 375px first; both are read alone, late, on a phone. Fee and access tables reflow to stacked label and value pairs. Nothing scrolls sideways.

READING CONTROLS

In the header of every page, not on an accessibility page. Text size, line spacing and calm mode, remembered on the device. Named *Reading* and framed as making the site easier to read — not as a mode for a category of person.

CONTACT

Say who receives it, that they are not a therapist, what is required (a way to reply), what is optional (everything else, including what the problem is), the response time, and what happens after that.

DELIBERATELY ABSENT

Testimonials · outcome claims · a condition or diagnosis menu · a credentials grid as the primary way the team is presented · newsletter capture, pop-ups and chat widgets · animation on scroll · photographs of children · scarcity or urgency language · a *Book now* anywhere on the site

WHY EACH OF THOSE IS ABSENT

A testimonial from a family in therapy cannot be published without a consent problem. An outcome claim is a promise Harbour has already refused to make. A pop-up interrupts a reader who is already close to leaving. And a *Book now* describes a commitment the first step does not involve.

HOW WE WILL CHECK THE BUILD

A first-time reader can find the fee in the first screen. A young person can find the confidentiality rule without scrolling past it. A parent can reach the door, the parking and the stairs from any page in two steps. And the site works with images off, at 200% text, and on a five-year-old phone.

The whole direction, on one page.

ORGANISATIONAL IDENTITY

A five-person therapy centre in one building in Stroud, working with children, teenagers, parents and families – small enough that nobody is handed between practitioners, and candid enough to say when it is not the right place.

PHILOSOPHY

The structure around the hour – the same room, held beginnings and endings, a privacy rule known in advance – is part of the care rather than the administration around it. Harbour’s position, stated as Harbour’s.

VOICE

Plain, specific, composed, unhurried, dry in places. Warm by accuracy rather than by adjective. Never cheerful by default and never brave on the reader’s behalf.

IDENTITY IDEA

One arch, drawn once – the building’s own opening, open at the base, carrying no symbolism beyond the building.

VISUAL DIRECTION

Limestone and Harbour green, stone for labels, one silt hairline. Four route colours that mark position and nothing else. Newsreader for the place, Inter for the facts. Drawings inside, four photographs outside, no people in either.

PRACTICAL FACTS, AS PUBLISHED

£65 · 50 minutes · free twenty-minute first call · family sessions fortnightly · review at session six, then roughly every eight · two to four weeks’ wait · no referral needed

PEOPLE TO REACH

Four readerships, held apart: children of roughly four to eleven, young people to eighteen, parents and carers on their own, and whole families – many arriving unsure they qualify.

CORE MESSAGE

We will tell you what happens before it happens.

DESIRED FEELING

Oriented, unhurried, not yet committed, and able to stop.

WEBSITE PRIORITY

Let a tired parent or a suspicious teenager rehearse the whole first visit – room, sequence, price and privacy rule – before making any contact at all.

SERVICE PRINCIPLE

Say in advance what will happen, then do what was said – including the reviews, the referrals elsewhere, and the ending.

NOT ON THE SITE

Testimonials, outcome claims, a diagnosis menu, credential grids as the team page, photographs of children, and any *Book now*.

THE ONE TEST

Never make somebody ask for information they are frightened to ask for.

Does this sound like Harbour?

Once you approve it, this Blueprint is the agreed direction for the website. The build then works from these pages, so the time goes into making the site good instead of settling the same questions twice. Clarity now is what removes the guesswork later.

Read it once quickly and once slowly. Where something is factually wrong, correct it. Where something is right but badly put, say so – that is an equally useful correction. Where you disagree with a recommendation, say what you would want instead, or simply say it is not you, and we will find the version that is.

Two things need a clinician's eye rather than a designer's: everything this document says about children, privacy, endings and families, and everything it implies about what Harbour can and cannot take on. If a sentence claims more than you would claim to a parent, mark it. Nothing on those subjects will be published in a form you have not agreed.

Two consolidated rounds of revision are included at this stage. One person holding the pen, with everyone's comments gathered into a single reply, produces a better document and a faster build.

Portfolio note — Harbour is a fictional therapy centre created by Alexander Watson Studio to demonstrate the Practice Clarity Blueprint. No discovery process took place, and no qualification, registration, membership, safeguarding arrangement, fee, address, clinical claim or quoted statement in this document is real. This note appears only in portfolio editions.

WHAT TO REVIEW

- Organisational facts, staff and services
- The philosophy, and how strongly it is put
- Everything written about children and young people
- The confidentiality wording, in both directions
- Safeguarding and crisis boundaries
- The four audiences, and whether they are the right four
- What we have assumed is blocking contact (page 07)
- The message and the voice
- The identity and the arch
- Colour and typography
- Imagery, and whether the building may be photographed
- Accessibility and the Reading control
- The organising assumption and requirements on pages 16 and 17
- Fees, access information and the contact process
- The outstanding facts listed on page 02

AFTER APPROVAL

Design begins from the direction agreed here, so the website can focus on bringing it to life instead of reopening the same decisions.

